

Tuesday, 16 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

26° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

23° 16°

MANCHESTER

Rain

23° 14°

GLASGOW

Rain

17° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Boy, 2, in hospital after nursery playground car crash.

A 63-year-old woman is arrested on suspicion of causing serious injury by dangerous driving.

UK · NEWS

2

Myles Smith 'so happy' to perform homecoming gig.

The rising star plays hits including Stargazing and Drive Safe to hundreds of fans in Luton.

UK · NEWS

3

Palestine Action ban is lawful, Court of Appeal rules.

The Home Office had challenged a High Court ruling that the group's proscription should be quashed.

UK · NEWS

4

Reform pledges new tax on hiring foreign workers.

The party says the move would allow it to reverse last year's National Insurance rise for British workers.

UK · NEWS

5

PC who died in line of duty parents' 'greatest joy'.

Jess Turnbull's parents say she was full of "energy, determination and kindness".

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 For your ears only: How music brought the new James Bond game to life.**
The BBC went behind the scenes as the score for the blockbuster James Bond video game was recorded.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Author Chimamanda Adichie accuses hospital of stalling review into son's death.**
Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie's 21-month old son died in a Lagos hospital, which she says is trying to stop an inquest into the circumstances of his death.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Married at First Sight Australia stars not told partners had drug and violence convictions.**
Stars of the hit TV show say they did not know their on-screen husbands had previous convictions.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 David Hockney depicted a 'peaceful, gay paradise' when homosexuality was a crime.**
The painter broke social taboos by celebrating same-sex relationships in his art.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Art's great innovator whose vivid paintings made him a household name.**
The proud Yorkshireman, who also painted iconic pictures of America, was routinely described as Britain's greatest artist.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

Vozinha heroics help Cape Verde hold Spain to goalless draw.

European champions Spain were held to surprise 0-0 draw by debutants Cape Verde in their World Cup opener, with 40-year-old goalkeeper Vozinha producing a standout performance for his side in their Group H clash.

SPORT · UK

2

Why Shinnecock may not offer the US Open test it has in the past.

After the past two US Opens at the New York course descended into controversy, tournament organisers say they have learned lessons, writes Iain Carter.

SPORT · UK

3

Empty seat at World Cup for imprisoned French sports journalist.

A seat is being left empty in the press box at every France game at the World Cup to highlight the case of a French football writer who is in prison in Algeria.

SPORT · UK

4

Cox and Baker to make Test debuts at The Oval.

Essex batter Jordan Cox and Hampshire fast bowler Sonny Baker will make their England debuts in the second Test against New Zealand.

SPORT · UK

5

Stones goes from brink of retirement to World Cup 'pure joy'.

John Stones' selection for England's World Cup squad may have raised a few eyebrows but the player says he had to "dig deep" to secure his place in the 26-man travelling party.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that listening to certain classical music can significantly improve plant growth.**
Scientists played various genres to different plants and found that classical compositions seemed to encourage faster and stronger development. Perhaps a little Mozart for your monstera?
- 2 The enduring appeal of local market day is making a strong comeback, with communities embracing handmade crafts and fresh produce.**
Shoppers are enjoying the personal touch and unique items found at these bustling hubs, often reconnecting with local artisans and growers.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the benefits of a 'favourite mug' for boosting morning morale.**
Research indicates that using a preferred cup can make hot drinks taste better and even reduce stress, adding a little joy to the start of your day.
- 4 There's a growing trend for 'community noticeboards' to go digital, making it easier for neighbours to share news and services.**
From lost pets to local events, these online hubs are fostering stronger connections and helping residents stay informed about their area.
- 5 A fascinating report reveals that early birds are more likely to have a tidy home.**
Those who rise with the sun often use the quiet morning hours for light chores, setting a calm and organised tone for the day ahead.
- 6 The art of 'pickleball' is taking the nation by storm, offering a fun and accessible sport for all ages.**
Combining elements of tennis, badminton, and table tennis, it's a great way to get active and socialise without too much intensity.
- 7 New research suggests that the smell of freshly baked bread can genuinely make people feel more generous and helpful.**
Scientists found that participants exposed to the aroma were more likely to assist strangers, proving the power of a comforting scent.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to discreetly 'correcting' what in a public place, even if it's not our responsibility?

ANSWER: A MISALIGNED DISPLAY IN A SHOP, A CROOKED PICTURE FRAME IN A WAITING ROOM, OR EVEN A WONKY SIGN!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'achievement' instantly makes them feel accomplished and satisfied. What came out on top?

ANSWER: SUCCESSFULLY PARALLEL PARKING ON THE FIRST ATTEMPT, OR FINDING THAT PERFECT ITEM IN A CLUTTERED DRAWER!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'colour' just instantly makes you feel happy, calm, or energetic?**
Is there a specific colour that just brightens your day, whether it's in your clothes, your home, or even just in nature? And why do you think it has such an effect on you?

- **We all have those little 'rituals' we stick to, especially when preparing for a special occasion or a big event, don't we?**
Do you have a particular routine or a little habit you always do before a big day out, a celebration, or perhaps even just a trip to the shops? We'd love to hear about your quirky pre-event traditions!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Apparently, a group of squirrels is known as a 'scurry', but if they're all very busy, it's called a 'hurry'!

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually started in a baker's shop on Pudding Lane.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The inventor of the Pringle's can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one.
- A polar bear's skin is actually black, even though their fur appears white.
- The world's largest hot desert, the Sahara, is growing in size.
- The sound of crickets chirping can actually be used to estimate the air temperature.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- The small plastic table often found in the middle of a pizza box is called a 'pizza saver' or 'package saver'.

On this day

Day 167 of the year, 198 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Leonard P. Howell (Rastafari); Bloomsday (Dublin, Ireland); Christian feast days: Aurelianus of Arles; Christian feast days: Aureus of Mainz (and his sister Justina). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Tom Harrell, American trumpet player and composer
- 1968 — James Patrick Stuart, American actor
- 1941 — Lamont Dozier, American songwriter and producer (died 2022)
- 1943 — Joan Van Ark, American actress
- 1993 — Gnash, American singer, songwriter, rapper, DJ and record producer
- 1947 — Tom Malone, American trombonist, composer, and producer
- 1974 — Joseph May, British-born Canadian-American actor
- 1957 — Ian Buchanan, Scottish-American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1955 — In a futile effort to topple Argentine President Juan Perón, rogue aircraft pilots of the Argentine Navy drop several bombs upon an unarmed crowd demonstrating in favor of Perón in Buenos Aires, killing 364 and injuring at least 800. At the same time on the ground, some soldie...
- 1958 — Imre Nagy, Pál Maléter and other leaders of the 1956 Hungarian Uprising are executed.
- 1972 — The largest single-site hydroelectric power project in Canada is inaugurated at Churchill Falls Generating Station.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2000 — The Secretary-General of the UN reports that Israel has complied with United Nations Security Council Resolution 425, 22 years after its issuance, and completely withdrew from Lebanon. The Resolution does not encompass the Shebaa farms, which is claimed by Israel, Syria and Le...
- 1995 — The Astronomy Picture of the Day website is launched.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2002 — Padre Pio is canonized by the Roman Catholic Church.

2013 — A multi-day cloudburst, centered on the North Indian state of Uttarakhand, causes devastating floods and landslides, becoming the country's worst natural disaster since the 2004 tsunami.

- 2010 — Bhutan becomes the first country to institute a total ban on tobacco.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 168 of the year, 197 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Albert Chmielowski; Christian feast day: Botolph (England and Scandinavia); Christian feast day: Gondulphus of Berry; Christian feast day: Hervé. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Timothy Wright, American gospel singer, pastor (died 2009)
- 1967 — Eric Stefani, American keyboard player and composer
- 2000 — Odessa A'zion, American actress
- 1940 — Chuck Rainey, American bassist
- 1975 — Joshua Leonard, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Gregg Rolie, American rock singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1942 — Roger Steffens, American actor and producer
- 1970 — Michael Showalter, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1972 — Watergate scandal: Five White House operatives are arrested for burgling the offices of the Democratic National Committee during an attempt by members of the administration of President Richard M. Nixon to illegally wiretap the political opposition as part of a broader campaig...
- 1953 — Cold War: East Germany Workers Uprising: In East Germany, the Soviet Union orders a division of troops into East Berlin to quell a rebellion.
- 1960 — The Nez Perce tribe is awarded \$4 million for 7 million acres (28,000 km2) of land undervalued at four cents/acre in the 1863 treaty.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1972 — Watergate scandal: Five White House operatives are arrested for burgling the offices of the Democratic National Committee during an attempt by members of the administration of President Richard M. Nixon to illegally wiretap the political opposition as part of a broader campaig...
- 2015 — Nine people are killed in a mass shooting at Emanuel African Methodist Episcopal Church in Charleston, South Carolina.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026

FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026

WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)